

Homage to the Three Jewels

Toh 821 · Derge Kangyur

Homage to the Three Jewels. This short text is a verse of homage and auspicious invocation addressed to the seven buddhas of the past, beginning with the Blessed One Vipasyī—born into a splendid royal lineage in an age when human lifespans lasted eighty thousand years, and who awakened fully beneath the śrīṣa tree in the beautiful city named in the opening lines. Likely composed in Sanskrit, it survives in Tibetan translation and belongs to the genre of auspicious verses (bkra shis, maṅgala) recited for blessing and good fortune by invoking the succession of past tathāgatas. As Toh 821 in the Kangyur, it is classified among the short dhāraṇī and ritual verse texts, reflecting a broader tradition of praising the lineage of buddhas as a source of protection and auspiciousness for those who recite or hear such verses.

Colophon

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Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.